HUMAN–ROBOT INTERACTION • MUSEUM GUIDE ROBOT • NTNU MUSEUM, TAIPEI

Persona 03

The Focused Learner

Accompanied but not curious about robots • wants clear explanations only



Daniel Mercer

FICTIONAL RESEARCH PERSONA

"I do not need a robot with a personality. I need clear explanations I can trust, in English."

SNAPSHOT

OCCUPATION
International PhD student, urban studies

AGE
29 years

CITY OF RESIDENCE
Taipei, Taiwan

FAMILY STATUS
Single, university dorm

EDUCATION LEVEL
Master's degree, PhD in progress

LANGUAGES
English fluent, basic Mandarin

VISITS
4–6 a year, alone, weekdays

PROFILE SCORES

Interest in robots	■□□□□
Wish for guidance	■■■■□
Need for detail	■■■■■
Patience for gimmicks	■□□□□
Privacy concern	■■■□□

Design assumptions, not survey data.

WHO HE IS

Daniel is a doctoral student who researches cities and public space. He visits the museum to understand the **history and context** behind what he sees. Labels are mostly in Mandarin, so he welcomes someone that explains in English. He has no interest in how the robot works: it is simply a **moving audio guide**.

THE CORE INSIGHT

He accepts company but does not want entertainment. The value of the robot is the quality, depth and language of its explanations.

VISIT MOTIVATION & GOALS

WHY HE COMES

- Understand the **history and meaning** of the exhibits
- Collect material and ideas for his research
- Make up for labels he cannot read

WHAT HE NEEDS

- Accurate explanations in English
- A short version first, more depth on request
- Names, dates and sources he can write down

INTERACTION PROFILE & PAIN POINTS

HOW HE INTERACTS

- Robot comfort neutral, smartphone comfort high
- Lets the robot lead, then asks for more detail
- Uses his phone for transcripts and translation

WHAT BOTHERS HIM

- Jokes, small talk and show-off features
- Explanations only in Mandarin or too shallow
- No sources, or facts he cannot verify

BELIEFS ABOUT ROBOTS

TOOL
"It is a guide, not a friend. I only care if it explains well."

ACCURATE
"A wrong date is worse than no answer at all."

LANGUAGE
"If it speaks English clearly, it already beats the wall text."

HE VALUES THE ROBOT WHEN…

The explanation is **correct, structured and in English**. It starts with a summary and offers **more detail on request**. He can read a **transcript or sources** on his phone afterwards. It follows his pace, pauses when he stops, and can be skipped or silenced with one tap.

DESIGN RULES FOR OUR MUSEUM GUIDE ROBOT

- **Content first:** no jokes, dances or filler talk by default
- **Layered answers:** 30-second summary, then deeper on request
- **Language choice:** English and Mandarin at the start
- **Sources and notes:** QR code with transcript and references
- **Pace control:** follow, pause, skip and repeat on demand
- **Calm style:** neutral voice, steady and unobtrusive

FICTIONAL PERSONA FOR DESIGN RESEARCH. NAME, DETAILS AND SCORES ARE INVENTED TO GUIDE THE NTNU MUSEUM GUIDE-ROBOT DESIGN; VALIDATE WITH REAL VISITOR INTERVIEWS.